



The Planna

*Your Event. Your Budget. Your Vendors. All
in One Place.*



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Product Name	The Planna
Version	1.0
Status	Concept / Pre-Development
Market	Nigeria (Phase 1)
Platform	iOS & Android (Web — Phase 2)
Date	2026

1.0 Product Overview

The Planna is a mobile marketplace designed to simplify event planning for individuals and organisations across Nigeria. The platform operates as a hybrid model, bringing together both independent vendors (such as caterers, decorators, photographers, entertainers, and more) and professional event planners onto a single, easy-to-navigate app.

Users can browse by location, event type, and budget; view portfolios and verified reviews; and interact directly with their chosen vendor or planner, all without leaving the platform. For those who cannot afford a full event planner, The Planna provides tools for self-coordination right at their fingertips. For those who can, it offers a curated directory of planners segmented by pricing tier, so affordability is never uncertain.

For vendors and planners, The Planna provides meaningful visibility and access to a wider audience, addressing a real gap in the Nigerian market where many skilled businesses remain hard to discover outside of personal referrals.

Core Value Proposition: The Planna removes the stress, guesswork, and back-and-forth of sourcing event vendors and planners, giving users everything they need to plan any occasion confidently, within budget, from one place.

2.0 Problem Statement

Origin Story: The Planna was conceived from direct personal experience. While planning an event, the founder faced the overwhelming reality that most Nigerians face. Hours spent searching for vendors, endless WhatsApp messages, referrals that didn't fit the budget, and no single place to compare, verify, and book. The Planna exists to solve that problem.

Planning an event, whether a wedding, birthday, graduation, or corporate function, is a significant undertaking. Individuals and organisations across Nigeria consistently experience the following pain points:

- **Fragmented vendor discovery:** There is no centralised platform where users can find, compare, and engage vendors across all event categories. Discovery relies almost entirely on referrals and social media searches, which are time-consuming and unreliable.
- **Budget opacity:** Finding vendors who work within a specific budget requires multiple conversations before pricing becomes clear. This wastes time and creates frustration, particularly for users on tight budgets.
- **Coordination overload:** Managing multiple vendors across different channels, such as WhatsApp, phone calls, and email, creates significant coordination stress, especially for individuals balancing event planning with full-time work.
- **Limited visibility for vendors:** Many skilled vendors and planners outside of major cities, or without strong social media followings, struggle to reach potential clients despite offering quality services.
- **No access to verified reviews:** Users have no reliable way to assess vendor quality before committing, leaving them dependent on word-of-mouth that may not reflect current standards.

2.1 Solution

The Planna addresses these problems through a hybrid marketplace that combines vendor discovery, event planner booking, in-app communication, verified reviews, and budget-based filtering in one seamless mobile experience. Users who want to self-coordinate can build their own vendor lineup category by category. Those who prefer to hand over the reins can browse planners filtered by pricing tier and location.

3.0 Product Features

i. Vendor & Planner Marketplace

A unified directory hosting both independent vendors (catering, decoration, photography, entertainment, and venues) and professional event planners. Users can browse from the same interface and choose the level of support that suits them.

ii. Location-Based Discovery

GPS-enabled search surfaces vendors and planners closest to the user's location. Manual location input is also supported for users planning events in other cities.

iii. Budget Filtering

Vendors and planners display pricing tiers clearly on their profiles. Users can filter results by budget range, eliminating the need for preliminary price conversations before engagement.

iv. Portfolio Showcases

Every vendor and planner profile includes a gallery of past work in images and videos, giving users visual evidence of quality before they make contact.

v. Event Package Builder

Users planning without a full event planner can build a custom event package by selecting vendors category by category, creating a coordinated lineup suited to their event type and budget.

vi. In-App Messaging

A secure, real-time messaging system allows users to communicate directly with vendors or planners within the app, reducing reliance on external platforms and keeping all conversations in one place.

vii. Booking & Availability

Users can send booking requests, view real-time availability, and manage upcoming bookings through an integrated calendar view. Vendors can accept, decline, or propose alternatives.

viii. Verified Reviews & Ratings

Post-event reviews with star ratings and text feedback help future users make informed decisions. Vendors can respond publicly to reviews but cannot edit or remove user feedback.

ix. Personalised Recommendations

An algorithm surfaces vendor and planner suggestions based on the user's event type, location, budget, and past activity.

x. Notifications & Alerts

Real-time push notifications keep both users and vendors informed of booking updates, messages, payment confirmations, and upcoming event reminders.

4.0 Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Strengths	Gap The Planna Fills
Instagram	Massive reach; visual portfolio display	No search/filter, no booking, no budget transparency
NaijaEventPlanner	Nigeria-specific planner directory	Vendors not included, no in-app booking or messaging
Eventbrite Nigeria	Strong ticketing and event promotion	Focused on event attendance, not vendor/planner sourcing
EventsNow	Event management and promotion tools	Not a vendor marketplace; no budget-based discovery

5.0 SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
• Hybrid model where there are vendors and planners in one platform • Location-based discovery with budget filtering • Portfolio showcases build trust before engagement • Solves a real, lived pain point in the Nigerian market • In-app messaging reduces back-and-forth friction	• Initial vendor/planner onboarding effort • Dependency on user-generated reviews for credibility • Data quality relies on vendors keeping profiles current • High user acquisition costs at launch
OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
• Nigeria's events industry is growing rapidly • Low-cost smartphone penetration is increasing its reach • Partnership opportunities with payment providers • Expansion to other African markets post-Nigeria • Freemium model for vendors drives organic growth	• Established competitors (Instagram, NaijaEventPlanner) • Changing user preferences and platform fatigue • Regulatory and data compliance requirements • Economic downturns affecting discretionary spend

6.0 User Persona: The individual User



Blessing Chisom O.

Communication

Age	27
Salary	N10.8m p.a
Education	Bsc Industrial Chemistry
Occupation	Customer Success Manager

BACKGROUND

Blessing is planning her wedding while managing a demanding full-time role. She has a budget in mind, but no idea how to find reliable vendors who can work within it or how to coordinate them once found.

GOALS & NEEDS

Find vetted vendors (catering, decoration, photography) in her area. Compare pricing upfront without lengthy back-and-forth. Book and communicate with vendors in one place.

PAIN POINTS

Vendor referrals that don't match her budget. Hours spent on WhatsApp chasing responses. No way to verify quality before committing.

MOTIVATIONS

Efficiency | Transparency | Reliability | Ease of use

6.2 User persona two: The vendor



Ademide A.

Communication

Age 38

Occupation

Owner Catering business, Abuja

BACKGROUND

Ademide has run her catering business for six years and consistently receives glowing feedback from clients. However, almost all her bookings come through personal referrals. She has a basic Instagram page but limited time to manage it, and no website. She regularly loses potential clients to larger, better-known competitors despite offering comparable quality at lower prices.

GOALS & NEEDS

Gain visibility beyond her existing referral network. Showcase her portfolio of past events to build credibility with new clients. Receive and manage booking enquiries without needing to be tech-savvy. Grow her bookings consistently without heavy marketing spend.

PAIN POINTS

Invisible to clients outside her immediate network. No professional platform to display her work credibly. Inconsistent booking pipeline — feast or famine depending on referral activity. Time wasted on enquiries from clients whose budgets don't match her pricing.

MOTIVATIONS

Visibility | Consistent Booking | Simplicity | Growth

6.2 User persona three: The Event Planner



Emmanuel D.

Communication

Age 36

Occupation

Professional Event Planner, Port Harcourt

BACKGROUND

Emmanuel has managed events professionally for over ten years, handling 8–12 events annually ranging from intimate weddings to large corporate functions. He has a strong portfolio and a small team, but spends a disproportionate amount of time on client acquisition, attending networking events, managing social media, and following up on cold leads, time he would rather spend on delivery.

GOALS & NEEDS

Access a steady stream of pre-qualified client leads without heavy marketing effort. Showcase his portfolio and credentials on a platform clients already trust. Differentiate himself from unverified competitors through a verified badge. Manage initial client enquiries efficiently before converting to a formal engagement.

PAIN POINTS

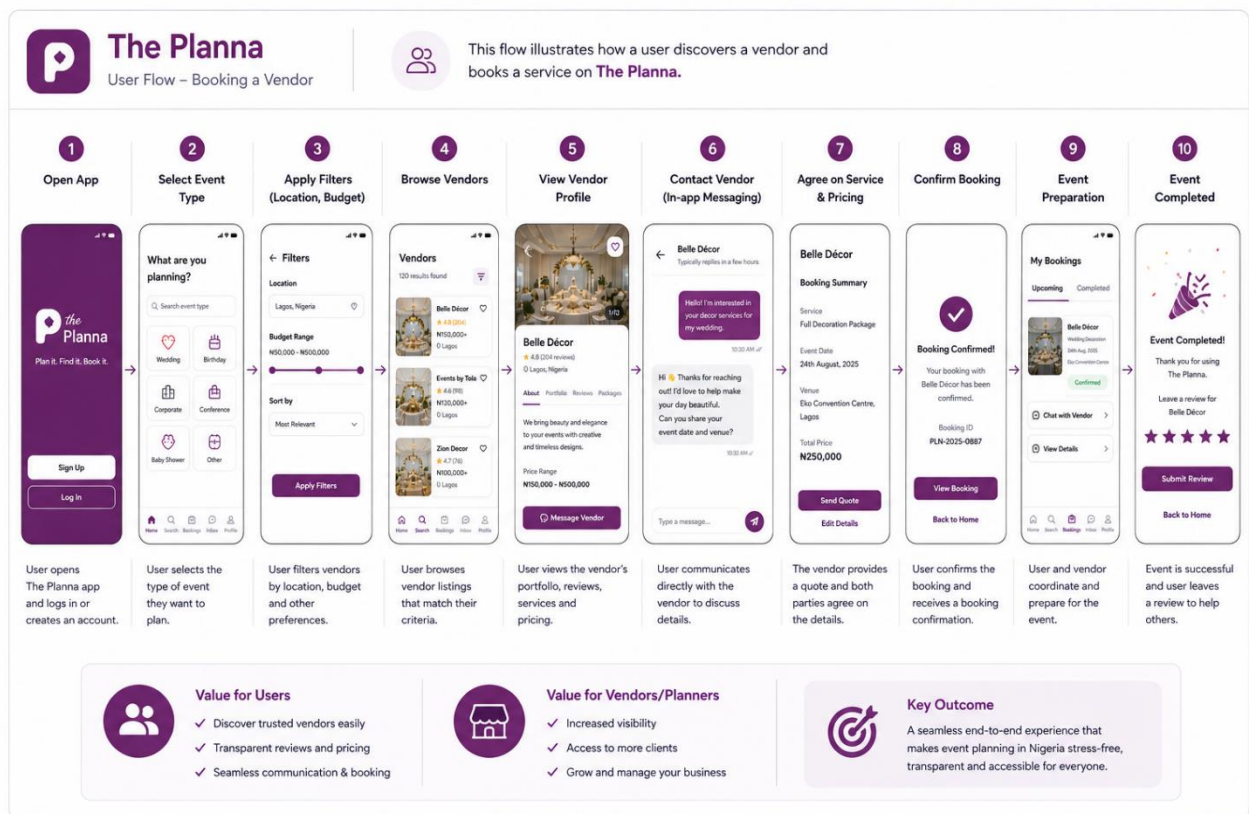
Too much time spent on client acquisition rather than event delivery. Competing on social media against planners with larger followings but less experience. No platform that distinguishes credible, established planners from newcomers. Enquiries from clients with unrealistic budgets wasting his time.

MOTIVATIONS

Credibility | Lead Quality | Efficiency | Professional Recognition

7.0 User Journey

- Discover:** User opens The Planna and selects their event type (e.g. wedding, birthday, corporate). They enter their location and set a budget range.
- Browse & Compare:** Search results surface nearby vendors by category and planners by pricing tier. The user browses profiles, views portfolios, and reads verified reviews.
- Build or Book:** Users planning independently use the Event Package Builder to select vendors across categories. Users who prefer a planner select one directly and send a booking inquiry.
- Communicate:** All conversations happen in-app via the secure messaging system, no external WhatsApp threads, no lost information.
- Confirm & Pay:** The user confirms the booking, makes a payment or deposit through the app's integrated payment system, and receives a confirmation notification.
- Review:** After the event, the user leaves a rating and review to help future users make informed decisions.



8.0 Acceptance Criteria

8.1 User Registration & Profile Management

- Users and vendors/planners can register via email, phone number, or third-party accounts (Google, Facebook).
- Users set up a profile with name, contact details, location, and event preferences.
- Vendors create business profiles including service category, location, pricing tier, portfolio gallery, and contact details.

- Event planners include specialisation types, packages offered, and verified credentials where applicable.
- All profiles are editable and updatable at any time.

8.2 Search & Discovery

- Users can search by event type, location (GPS or manual), vendor/service category, and budget range.
- Search results display vendor name, rating, service summary, pricing tier, and distance.
- Results can be filtered and sorted by rating, price, or proximity.
- A separate tab allows users to browse event planners specifically, filtered by pricing tier.

8.3 Vendor & Planner Profiles

- Profiles display service description, pricing, portfolio gallery (images/video), reviews, ratings, and location map.
- Users can save or bookmark preferred vendors/planners for future reference.
- Average ratings are calculated automatically and displayed prominently on each profile.

8.4 Event Package Builder

- Users can create a custom event package by selecting vendors across multiple categories.
- The builder displays a running cost estimate as vendors are added.
- Users can swap vendors within a category without losing other selections.
- Completed packages can be saved and shared for reference.

8.5 Booking & Inquiry System

- Users can send booking requests with event date, type, guest count, and specific requirements.
- Vendors/planners can accept, decline, or propose amendments to requests.
- A calendar view shows availability and confirmed bookings for both parties.
- Booking confirmation triggers a notification to both the user and vendor/planner.

8.6 Payments

- Vendors and planners can set and update pricing for services and packages.
- Users can make secure payments via credit/debit card, mobile payment, or bank transfer.
- Partial payments and deposits are supported for larger bookings.
- Receipts and payment confirmations are issued automatically.

8.7 Reviews & Ratings

- Users can submit a star rating (1–5) and a written review after an event is completed.
- Vendors/planners can respond publicly to reviews but cannot edit or delete user feedback.
- Reviews are moderated by the admin to prevent abuse.

8.8 Messaging System

- Real-time in-app messaging between users and vendors/planners.
- Supports text and file/image attachments for sharing event briefs or mood boards.
- New message notifications delivered via push alert.

8.9 Admin Dashboard

- Admin can approve, suspend, or remove vendor/planner profiles before or after going live.
- Admin has access to analytics covering user engagement, booking trends, and platform revenue.
- Admin can manage and escalate disputes between users and vendors/planners.

8.10 Security & Privacy

- The app complies with applicable data protection regulations (NDPR, GDPR principles).
- All user data and payment information is encrypted and stored securely.
- Vendors' contact details are not shared with users until a booking is confirmed.
- Users can manage their own privacy settings and profile visibility.

8.11 Performance & Usability

- The app is fully responsive across iOS and Android devices.
- Search results, profile pages, and messages load within 3 seconds under normal conditions.
- The interface is intuitive and accessible, requiring no user manual to navigate.
- The platform is designed to handle a high volume of concurrent users without degradation.

8.12 Testing & Quality Assurance

- The app undergoes unit testing, integration testing, and user acceptance testing (UAT) before launch.
- Automated test cases cover critical paths: registration, search, booking, payment, and messaging.
- UAT feedback is incorporated into the final build prior to release.

8.13 Deployment & Maintenance

- The app is deployed to Google Play Store and Apple App Store with clear onboarding.
 - A scheduled maintenance and update cycle addresses bugs and introduces new features.
 - A help centre and in-app support channel are available from launch.
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9.0 Trust & Safety: Fraud Prevention Framework

As a two-sided marketplace handling bookings and payments, The Planna has a responsibility to protect both users and vendors from fraudulent activity. Trust is not just a technical concern; it is a core product feature. The following layered framework addresses fraud prevention at every stage of the user and vendor journey.

Design Principle: No vendor or event planner profile goes live on The Planna without passing through at least two verification gates. Trust is earned on this platform, not assumed.

Layer 1: Registration Controls

- **OTP phone verification:** Every new account must verify their phone number via a one-time password at sign-up, eliminating the majority of bot and throwaway account registrations.
- **Email verification:** A secondary confirmation link is sent to the registered email address before full account access is granted.
- **No profile published without verification:** Vendor and planner profiles remain in draft and are invisible to users until all verification steps are completed.

Layer 2: Vendor & Planner Identity Verification

- **Government-issued ID:** Individual vendors and planners must upload a valid form of ID (NIN slip, international passport, or driver's licence) during onboarding.
- **CAC registration number:** Vendors operating as a registered business must provide their Corporate Affairs Commission registration number, cross-referenced against Nigeria's public CAC register.
- **Admin approval gate:** Every new vendor and planner profile is manually reviewed and approved by a platform admin before going live. Unverifiable profiles are rejected with a clear explanation.
- **Pending Verification badge:** Profiles still undergoing full document review display a visible 'Pending Verification' status so users can make informed decisions.

Layer 3: In-Platform Trust Signals

- **Verified badge:** Profiles that have passed full identity and document verification display a prominent Verified badge, giving users an instant, reliable signal of credibility.
- **Contact details withheld until booking confirmed:** Vendor phone numbers and personal contact details are not visible to users until a booking request has been accepted, preventing the platform from being used to harvest contact information.
- **Escrow payment model:** Payments are held in escrow and released to the vendor or planner only after the event is completed, and the user confirms satisfactory delivery. This is the single most effective deterrent against payment fraud.
- **Portfolio authenticity checks:** Admin periodically cross-checks portfolio images to identify content lifted from other sources or competitor profiles.

Layer 4: Community Policing

- **Report a profile:** Users can flag any vendor or planner profile as suspicious directly from the app. Admin reviews flagged profiles within 24 hours.
- **Automated high-report flagging:** Profiles that accumulate a threshold number of reports are automatically suspended pending admin review.
- **Verified reviews only:** Users can only leave a review if a completed booking is on record, preventing fake positive or negative reviews.
- **Dispute resolution:** A structured process allows users and vendors to escalate issues to the admin, who can mediate, issue refunds from escrow, or permanently remove bad actors.

Layer 5: Ongoing Monitoring

- **Admin analytics flagging:** Unusual behaviour such as high message volumes with zero bookings, sudden review spikes, or repeated enquiries with no follow-through is flagged automatically for admin review.
 - **Periodic re-verification:** Vendors and planners are prompted annually to re-verify identity documents to ensure profile information remains current.
 - **Suspension and removal policy:** A clear, published policy outlines the conditions under which accounts are suspended or permanently removed, providing both deterrence and transparency.
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10.0 Success Metrics

The following KPIs will be used to evaluate the performance and growth of The Planna post-launch:

- **User Acquisition:** Number of registered users (individuals and vendors/planners) within 3, 6, and 12 months of launch.
 - **Booking Conversion Rate:** Percentage of profile views that result in a confirmed booking inquiry.
 - **Active Users:** Monthly active users (MAU) as a measure of platform engagement and retention.
 - **Vendor Retention:** Percentage of vendors/planners who maintain active, updated profiles after onboarding.
 - **Review Volume:** Number of verified post-event reviews submitted as a proxy for completed bookings.
 - **Average Rating:** Platform-wide average vendor/planner rating as a measure of service quality.
 - **Time to Booking:** Average time from first app open to first confirmed booking, a measure of UX efficiency.
 - **Net Promoter Score (NPS):** User likelihood to recommend The Planna to others, measured via periodic in-app surveys.
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11.0 Future Considerations

- Web platform (Phase 2) to complement the mobile app and serve corporate clients.
 - Verified badge programme for vendors who meet quality and responsiveness standards.
 - Freemium vendor model: basic listing is free, premium features (featured placement, analytics) are paid.
 - Integration with Nigerian payment gateways (Paystack, Flutterwave) for seamless local transactions.
 - Expansion to other African markets (Ghana, Kenya, South Africa) following traction in Nigeria.
 - AI-powered event budget estimator to help users understand realistic costs before browsing.
 - Collaborative planning tools for users to co-plan events with friends or family.
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